

The Cleverness of Ladies – Transcript

1 It was a slack time at the No. 1 Ladies' Detective Agency, the only detective agency in
2 Botswana. It would be wrong to say that nothing was going on – Mma Ramotswe, who
3 had founded the agency to deal with the problems of ladies (and others), knew that
4 something was always happening. People were always getting themselves into
5 unfortunate scrapes; they had always done this, and human nature showed no sign of
6 changing. No, the reason why things were quiet was that nobody was bringing anything to
7 the attention of the small detective agency at the back of Tlokweng Road Speedy Motors.

8 The garage business was owned by Mma Ramotswe's husband, Mr. J.L.B. Matekoni, who
9 everyone agreed was the finest mechanic in Botswana. She had been engaged to Mr.
10 J.L.B. Matekoni for rather a long time, and eventually he had married her. But some say this
11 was only as a result of clever plotting by the cunning matron of the Tlokweng Orphan
12 Farm, Mma Potokwani.

13 Yet such a view was uncharitable. Mr J.L.B. Matekoni was sometimes a bit indecisive,
14 and marriage proved to be only one of the things that he was indecisive about.

The Cleverness of Ladies

By Alexander McCall Smith

Little, Brown (Quick Reads)

Chapter 1 Page 1

